TCHP: docetaxel, carboplatin, trastuzumab and pertuzumab

All four medicines are given by infusion on Day 1 of a 21-day cycle, for six cycles before surgery. Surgery findings guide the postoperative treatment. There is no routine take-home chemotherapy pump.

Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair / scalp

Docetaxel

Hair loss is expected with docetaxel. Discuss scalp cooling where appropriate and hair / scalp support.

2 Mouth

Chemotherapy

Painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

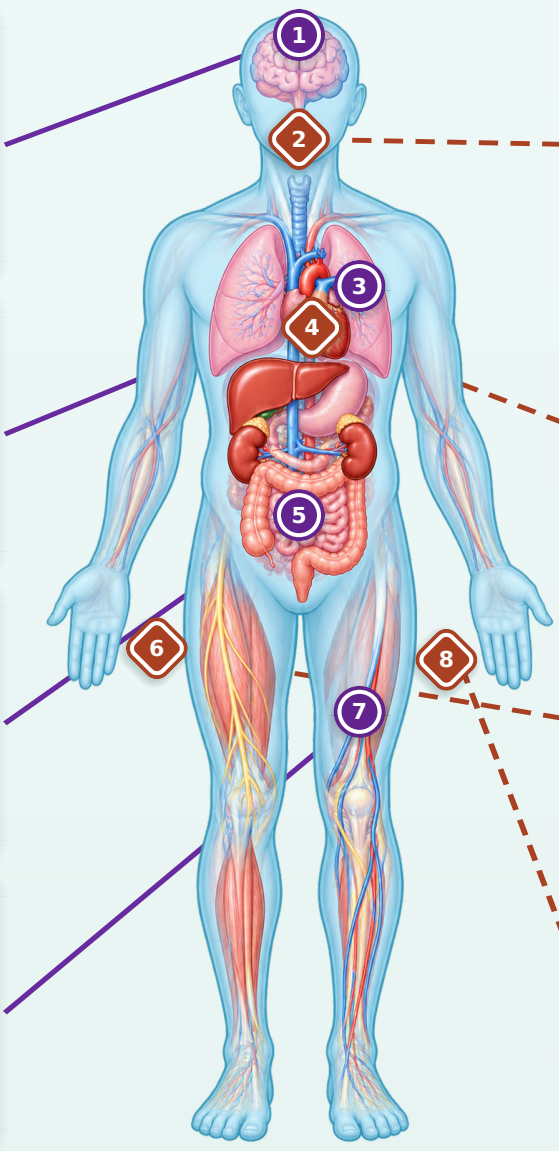
HER2 treatment

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart / circulation

HER2 treatment

Fainting, chest pain or severe breathing difficulty: urgent help. Keep scheduled cardiac checks.



5 Bowel

Pertuzumab / docetaxel

Report diarrhoea promptly, especially with poor intake, fever or dizziness.

6 Nerves / joints

Docetaxel

Report numbness, tingling or difficulty with buttons or walking before the next dose.

7 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy and the whole regimen

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Treatment medicines

Severe rash, blistering or yellow skin/eyes needs prompt advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Docetaxel

- Low blood counts, infection and sepsis
- Hair loss, mouth soreness and fatigue
- Numbness / tingling; sometimes lasting
- Fluid retention and nail changes
- Allergic infusion reaction

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Allergic reaction, sometimes after previous exposure
- Kidney or electrolyte changes

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Pertuzumab

- Diarrhoea and dehydration
- Infusion / allergic reaction
- Heart pumping-function reduction
- Rash and fatigue

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Before each infusion

Confirm steroid and anti-sickness instructions; ask whether growth-factor injections are prescribed.

Baseline and ongoing checks

Echo before Cycle 1, then every 12 weeks (around Cycle 5 if on schedule), continuing through HER2 treatment and at completion. Bloods before each cycle. Breast imaging is arranged for response / surgery planning; there is no routine CT each cycle.

Line and day-ward plan

A cannula, PICC or port may be used. Ask about insertion, wound care and whom to call for line symptoms.

Recovery and support

Report diarrhoea or numbness early. Ask about fertility, scalp cooling, nutrition and practical support.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00722/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.